



iPod Nano

The latest iPod Nano has a radio, video camera and microphone



Nokia Netbooks

The Nokia Booklet 3G will sell for less than \$500, have a 10-inch screen and built in GPS navigation chip

Tech Treats

Groovy gifting ideas for Diwali

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It's that time of the year when the air is filled with festivities. Come Diwali, and you're bombarded with discounts and offers. So, if you have geeks for friends who prefer gadgets to sweets, here's a list of technological thingamajigs categorised according to your buying power.

Starters (Less than Rs. 1,000)

USB pen drives

Flash drives start from Rs. 200 (1 GB) all the way to Rs. 4,000 (32 GB) and above. They are bare necessity and can be stuff to show around. One that stands out makes for a cool gift. The recently launched JetFlash V70 by Transcend, with eco-friendly rubber makes it



Rubber drives are trendy and almost indestructible

highly durable, shock-resistant and dust and water-proof. These are available in different colours too – 4 GB (Purple), 8 GB (Orange) and 16 GB (Red) – and, best of all the prices are highly competitive – Rs. 600, Rs. 900 and Rs. 1,600 respectively.

Pop-Up Toaster

Here's one for the kitchen and whether your mom works or not, it'll be a welcome convenience. Usha Lexus toasters come for Rs. 900 or less while Inalsa ones hover around the Rs. 1,000-mark. In fact, considering that it is not just moms who toast bread, you can gift your dad one.



Get your daily bread faster

Battery operated mobile charger

An emergency cell phone charger is what travellers always need. You can get one for less than Rs. 160 in time for the Diwali holiday travel. These are pocket-sized, lightweight and use 4 AAA batteries/pencil cells and are compatible with most cell phone brands. Visit your local mobile store for the best deals on this one.

Electric Kettle

It's amazing how cheap kitchen accessories have got. The Bajaj Cordless Electric Kettle comes between Rs. 799 to 899. Plug it in and you can make tea, boil milk or water in a moment. Give your mom one, and then settle for a Kettle proceed to show her what a refreshing cup of tea you can make.



Settle for a Kettle

Hair Dryer

There was a time when hair dryers were only meant for women. Although you can still gift your sister one, these days, even males sporting long hair use them. Hair dryers are way within budget – while the Philips HP 4823 is less than Rs. 700, Panasonic and Remington hair dryers are a little below Rs. 1000.



The Philips HP 4823 even comes in feminine colours

TV Video Game

If you're on a shoestring budget and you want to please kids less than age 12 this Diwali, gift them the good old TV video game that you get at every local toy shop. It comes with joysticks, a 'gun' and lots of games that can be played on the television – all for less than Rs. 500. Just pray that the kid hasn't heard of the Xbox or PlayStation yet.

Getting your wallet (Rs. 1,000 to Rs. 2,500)

MP3/MP4 Player

Every time you think everyone's got one, just remind yourself that everyone who has already got one usually wants another, better one. Innumerable brands – Chinese *et al.* – clutter the market and spoil you for choice. Some of these are even below Rs. 1,000. And then there's the quintessential iPod. The 1 GB iPod Shuffle is priced below the Rs. 2,500 threshold and is going to make your friends flip. You can even change the skin to the stereotypical pink for your sister or girl friend. Or get it for your younger siblings to finally let them have their own private listening device. Cheaper players are available for much less, if you're not fussy about brands.



The Shuffle still rules

Cell Phone

If there's someone who hasn't got a mobile phone yet, or has an old style one – give him/her a colour screen cell phone. The Nokia 1209 (Rs. 1,500) and the Nokia 1650 (Rs. 1,765) not only have colour screens, but offer other features



Cell phones for starters

Five things to remember when going hunting for gadget gifts

1. Make a List: First thing you could do is make a list of exactly how many people you would like to gift something this Diwali – and who they are.
2. Choose the right Gift: Everyone in your list will probably have different tastes. If you like something, it doesn't mean the one you are gifting would like it.
3. Budget: Make a total of how much money you are going to spend on gifts – in fact it would help if you came up with a definite figure for how much you are definitely not going to spend this season. Don't forget Christmas and New Year are fast approaching and credit card interest rates are still nasty in our country.
4. Finding the best prices: This is the toughest part. The most obvious thing to do would be to leg it to a dozen shops and compare them for discounts and competitive prices. But then, not all shops have everything. Something more sensible would be to check the various internet shopping sites. Check out online shopping portals.
5. Wrap them up: This may sound inane but the truth is that gifts often lose their effect when not wrapped up – or not wrapped up well enough. And for some reason, we tend to gift gadgets as we buy them – in shopping mall plastic bags. Don't lose out on the element of surprise – cover it up and watch them brighten up as it unravels.

